

CS 156 SPRING 2026

Release Notes

proj-dining

TEAM

Team o8

REPOSITORY

github.com/ucsb-cs156-s26/proj-dining-s26-o8

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Changes Users Will Notice

From the start of the course to now, the app has grown from mainly letting users view dining menus and post reviews into a more complete review and moderation system. Users can now edit reviews, admins and moderators have more tools to manage the app, and logged-in users can use review statistics to help decide where and what to eat.

Review Statistics

A new Statistics section was added to the navbar. Before, there was no stats area in the app. Now, logged-in users can open a Statistics overview page and view several pages that summarize approved review data.

The Statistics section includes:

- **Best Rated Items**, showing the highest-rated menu items
- **Worst Rated Items**, showing the lowest-rated menu items
- **Dining Commons Averages**, showing the average score for each dining commons
- **Dining Commons Averages Over Time**, showing average scores by month
- **Meal Averages by Dining Commons**, showing average scores for meals like breakfast, lunch, dinner, and brunch at a selected dining commons

The best and worst rated item pages also include a time filter, so users can view results for all time, the last 6 months, the last month, or the last week.

Only approved reviews are used in these statistics. This keeps unmoderated review content from affecting the public stats.

Statistics ▼

Overview

Best Rated Items

Worst Rated Items

Commons Averages

Commons Over Time

Commons Meal Averages

Review Statistics

Pick a statistic below to help you decide where to eat your next meal.

Best Rated Items
See the highest rated menu items overall and in recent time windows.

View

Worst Rated Items
See the lowest rated menu items overall and in recent time windows.

View

Dining Commons Averages
Average review score for each dining commons.

View

Dining Commons Averages Over Time
Average review score for each dining commons by month.

View

Meal Averages by Dining Commons
Average review score for each meal at a dining commons.

View

Best Rated Items

Time period

All time

Item	Dining Commons	Meal	Station	Average Score	Reviews
Potatoes O'Brien (vgn)	carrillo	breakfast	Grill (Cafe)	4.00	3
Beef Fried Taco	de-la-guerra	dinner	Taqueria (East Side)	3.50	2
Whole Wheat Penne Pasta (vgn)	carrillo	dinner	Pasta	3.00	3
Fluffy Whole Wheat Waffles (v)	carrillo	breakfast	Grill (Cafe)	3.00	2
Chicken Noodle Soup	de-la-guerra	dinner	Blue Plate Special	3.00	1

Worst Rated Items

Time period

All time

Item	Dining Commons	Meal	Station	Average Score	Reviews
Lamb Greek Gyro	carrillo	lunch	Mongolian Grill	2.67	3
Oatmeal (vgn)	carrillo	breakfast	Grill (Cafe)	2.75	4
Whole Wheat Penne Pasta (vgn)	carrillo	dinner	Pasta	3.00	3
Fluffy Whole Wheat Waffles (v)	carrillo	breakfast	Grill (Cafe)	3.00	2
Chicken Noodle Soup	de-la-guerra	dinner	Blue Plate Special	3.00	1

Dining Commons Averages

Dining Commons	Average Score	Reviews
carrillo	3.06	16
de-la-guerra	3.33	3

Dining Commons Averages Over Time

Average rating per dining commons grouped by the month the meal was served. An averages-over-time graph is potentially coming soon.

Dining Commons	Month	Average Score	Reviews
carrillo	2026-05	3.06	16
de-la-guerra	2026-05	3.33	3

Meal Averages by Dining Commons

Dining Commons

Carrillo

Meal	Average Score	Reviews
breakfast	3.22	9
dinner	3.00	3
lunch	2.75	4

Review Editing

Users can now edit their own reviews. Before, the review edit page only showed a “Coming Soon” placeholder. Now, /reviews/edit/:id opens a real edit form.

The form fills in the review’s current item name, comments, star rating, and date served. Users can update the comments, stars, and date served. The item name cannot be changed, which keeps the review connected to the correct menu item.

After saving, the app shows a toast message and sends the user back when the update works.

Edit review with id 1

Coming soon!

Edit Review

Item Name

Cage Free Scrambled Eggs (v)

Comments

Yumm

Stars (1 to 5)

5

Date and Time Item was Served

05/21/2026, 12:06 AM

Update Review

Auto-Approved Star-Only Reviews

Reviews without written comments are now handled more smoothly. If a user submits a review with only stars and a date, the review is automatically approved instead of being sent to the moderation queue.

This also applies when the comment box is blank or only has spaces. Reviews with written comments still go through moderation like before.

This means star-only ratings can show up right away on item pages and in the statistics pages without waiting for a moderator.

My Reviews

Moderation Status	Item Id	Item Name	Score	Comments	Date Served	Dining Commons Code	Edit	Delete
APPROVED	18	Cage Free Scrambled Egg Whites (v)	★★★★★		5/20/2026	de-la-guerra	Edit	Delete
AWAITING_REVIEW	29	Grilled Ham	★★★★★	Good food	5/20/2026	de-la-guerra	Edit	Delete

Moderation Page Updates

The moderation area is now functional. Before, the moderation page was mostly a stub. Now, admins and moderators can use it to review user-submitted reviews and proposed aliases.

The main moderation page includes two sections:

- **Reviews Needing Moderation**
- **Aliases Needing Moderation**

Moderators and admins can approve or reject both reviews and aliases from these pages.

There is also a separate alias moderation page for moderators who only want to review proposed aliases.

Moderate ▾ My Rev

Moderator Page

Moderate Reviews

Moderation Page

Proposed Alias	Approve	Reject
wen	<button>Approve</button>	<button>Reject</button>

Moderation Page

Reviews Needing Moderation

Moderation Status	Item Id	Item Name	Score	Comments	Date Served	Dining Commons Code	Approve	Reject
AWAITING_REVIEW	147	Oatmeal (vgn)	☆☆	Eww	5/28/2026	carrillo	<button>Approve</button>	<button>Reject</button>
AWAITING_REVIEW	245	Herb & Garlic Crusted Catfish	☆☆	dsf	5/29/2026	de-la-guerra	<button>Approve</button>	<button>Reject</button>
AWAITING_REVIEW	244	Chicken Noodle Soup	☆☆☆☆☆	fa	5/29/2026	de-la-guerra	<button>Approve</button>	<button>Reject</button>
AWAITING_REVIEW	261	Sliced Pepper Jack Cheese (v)	☆☆☆☆☆	x	5/29/2026	carrillo	<button>Approve</button>	<button>Reject</button>

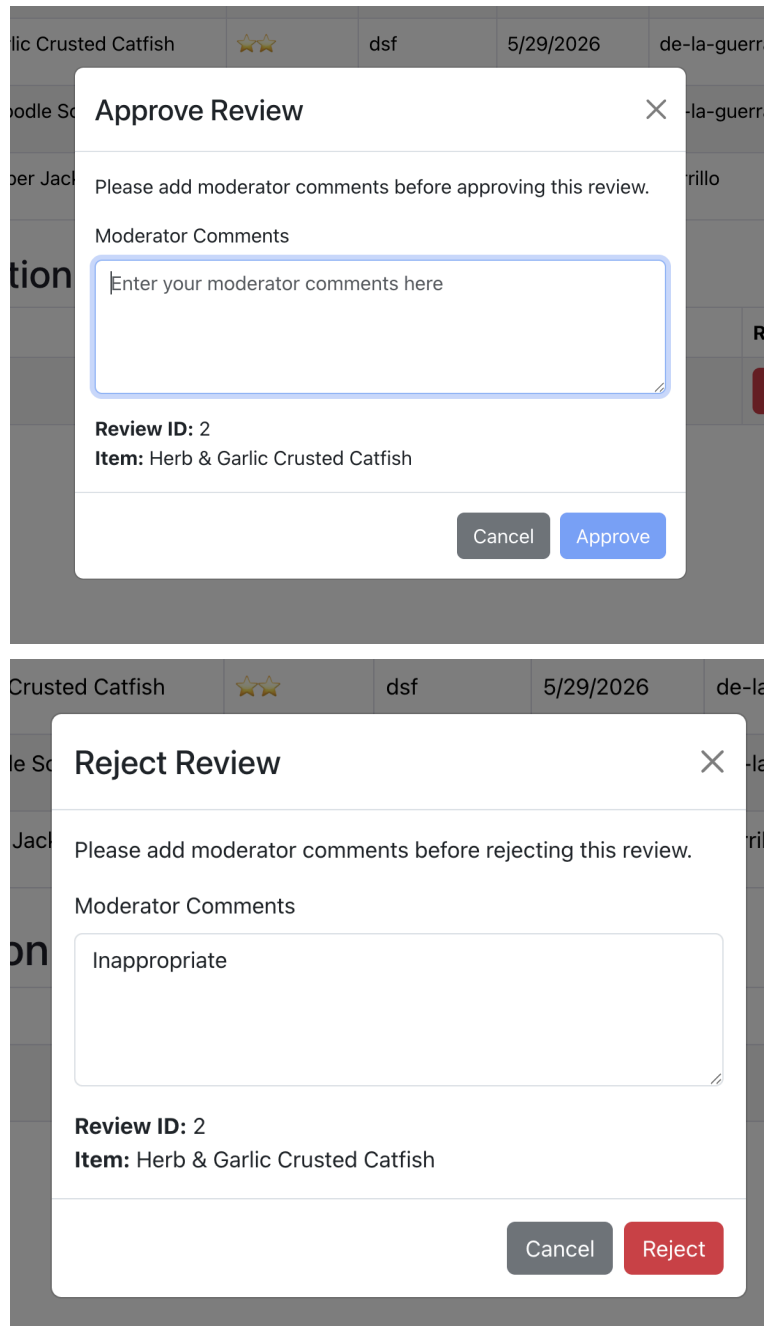
Aliases Needing Moderation

Proposed Alias	Approve	Reject
wen	<button>Approve</button>	<button>Reject</button>

Moderator Comments Modal

When a moderator approves or rejects a review, a popup now opens and asks them to enter a short comment. The submit button stays disabled until a comment is typed.

This makes sure every moderation decision has feedback attached to it. It also keeps the review table cleaner because the comments are entered in a modal instead of directly on the table.



Admin User Role Management

Admin users can now manage user roles directly from the **Admin Users** page. Before, admins had to use backend tools like Swagger or the database to change admin and moderator roles.

Now, the Users table includes:

- A **Toggle Admin** button

- A **Toggle Moderator** button

This lets admins update roles from the UI with one click. Admin emails that come from the app's environment settings are still protected, so those admin roles cannot be removed by mistake.

Users

id	First Name	Last Name	Email	Admin	Moderator	Alias	Proposed Alias	Status
1	Wendy	Contreras Martinez	wcontrerasmartinez@ucsb.edu	true	false	Anonymous User		
2	Derek	Kirschbaum	dgkirschbaum@ucsb.edu	true	false	Anonymous User		
3	Phill	Conrad	phtcon@ucsb.edu	true	false	Anonymous User		

Users

id	First Name	Last Name	Email	Admin	Moderator	Alias	Proposed Alias	Status	Toggle Admin	Toggle Moderator
1	Wendy	Contreras Martinez	wcontrerasmartinez@ucsb.edu	true	true	wenwen		Approved on 5/21/2026	<button>Toggle Admin</button>	<button>Toggle Moderator</button>
2	Wendy	Contreras Martinez	contreraswendy@gmail.com	false	true	chicken		Approved on 5/21/2026	<button>Toggle Admin</button>	<button>Toggle Moderator</button>

Clearer Alias Approval Status

The Users table also makes alias approval status easier to read. Before, approved aliases only showed the raw value APPROVED.

Now, when an alias is approved and has a valid approval date, the Status column shows the date in a clearer format, such as:

Approved on 5/21/2026

If the approval date is missing or invalid, the table still shows the plain status. Other statuses, such as rejected or awaiting review, are shown the same as before.

Add New Moderator Page

Admins now have a page where they can add a moderator by email. The form checks that the email is valid, sends the request to the backend, shows a success toast, and then returns the user to the home page.

One limitation is that this page does not have a navbar link yet, so it needs to be opened directly by route (/admin/moderators/create)

Add New Moderator

Email

contrerasmwendy@gmail.com

Create

Cancel

Add New Moderator

Email

not-valid-em



A valid email is required.

Create

Cancel

Average Ratings on Menu Item Pages

The main menu item table now shows average ratings correctly. Before, the Average Rating column would show “No reviews” even when approved reviews existed for that item.

Now, once a review is approved, the average rating appears on the menu item table. This makes the review flow work better from start to finish:

1. A user submits a rating.
2. The review is approved, or auto-approved if it has no comments.
3. The item's average rating updates on the menu page.

Breakfast

Item Name	Station	Average Rating	Review Item	All Reviews
Oatmeal (vgn)	Grill (Cafe)	No reviews	Review Item	All Reviews
Cream of Wheat (vgn)	Grill (Cafe)	No reviews	Review Item	All Reviews
Chicken Sausage Link	Grill (Cafe)	No reviews	Review Item	All Reviews
Strawberry Pancake (v)	Grill (Cafe)	No reviews	Review Item	All Reviews
Hash Browns (vgn)	Grill (Cafe)	No reviews	Review Item	All Reviews
Cage Free Scrambled Egg Whites (v)	Grill (Cafe)	No reviews	Review Item	All Reviews
Cage Free Eggs Scrambled (v)	Grill (Cafe)	No reviews	Review Item	All Reviews
Fluffy Whole Wheat Waffles (v)	Grill (Cafe)	No reviews	Review Item	All Reviews
Assorted Bagels & Condiments	Bakery	No reviews	Review Item	All Reviews
Blueberry Coffee Cake (v)	Bakery	No reviews	Review Item	All Reviews

Breakfast				
Toggle SortBy				
Item Name	Station	Average Rating	Review Item	All Reviews
Oatmeal (vgn)	Grill (Cafe)	3.0	Review Item	All Reviews
Bacon	Grill (Cafe)	3.7	Review Item	All Reviews
Apple Crepe w/Caramel Sauce	Grill (Cafe)	No reviews	Review Item	All Reviews
Hash Browns (vgn)	Grill (Cafe)	No reviews	Review Item	All Reviews
Cage Free Eggs Scrambled (v)	Grill (Cafe)	No reviews	Review Item	All Reviews
Cage Free Scrambled Egg Whites (v)	Grill (Cafe)	No reviews	Review Item	All Reviews
Fluffy Whole Wheat Waffles (v)	Grill (Cafe)	4.0	Review Item	All Reviews
Apple Bishop's Coffee Cake (v)	Bakery	No reviews	Review Item	All Reviews
Lemon Poppyseed Muffin (v)	Bakery	No reviews	Review Item	All Reviews

Smoother Navigation

Internal navbar links now use React navigation instead of full-page reloads. Links such as Admin, Moderate, My Reviews, and Statistics now move between pages more smoothly.

There is no major visual change, but the app feels faster because the page does not fully refresh when users click internal links. Backend tool links like Swagger and H2 Console still work the same way as before.

Overall User Summary

Overall, the app is now more useful and complete. Users can edit their reviews, see average ratings, and use statistics to compare dining options. Admins and moderators can manage roles, review aliases, moderate reviews, and leave feedback through the UI instead of relying only on backend tools.

Developer Notes

The main backend and frontend changes focused on reviews, moderation, role management, statistics, navigation, and build improvements.

Review and Moderation Changes

The review system now supports a full edit flow. The frontend can fetch a single review, show it in an edit form, and save updates back to the backend. The item name is disabled in the form so the review stays connected to the correct menu item.

Reviews with no comments are now automatically approved. A comment is treated as empty if it is null, an empty string, or only whitespace. If a review has written comments, it is still sent to moderation.

The moderation flow now supports moderator comments. A reusable moderation modal was added so approve and reject actions include required feedback before submission.

Developer details to be aware of:

- Single-review fetch support was added.
- Reviewer edit support was added.
- Review moderation now saves status and moderator comments together.
- Reviews needing moderation can be fetched for the moderation page.
- Review creation now auto-approves star-only reviews.
- Tests cover auto-approval, review editing, modal behavior, and moderation actions.

Role Management Changes

The app now uses separate role tables for admins and moderators instead of storing admin and moderator booleans directly on the users table.

This means role checks now come from the role tables and the admin email environment setting, not from old user columns.

Developer details to be aware of:

- Admin and moderator roles are stored in separate tables.
- The old admin and moderator columns were removed from the users table.
- User role information is now built from the role tables.
- Toggle admin and toggle moderator actions insert or delete role records.
- Admin emails from environment settings are protected.
- Any code that used old user admin/moderator fields should be updated to use the current role system.

Admin and Moderator Endpoints

The backend now includes endpoints for managing admins and moderators through role tables. This supports both toggle buttons and the create moderator page.

Developer details to be aware of:

- Admin users can be listed, added, and deleted.
- Moderator users can be listed, added, and deleted.
- Email normalization is handled before storing role emails.
- Deleting protected environment-based admins is blocked.
- The create moderator page sends the new moderator email to the backend.

Statistics Backend

A new statistics backend supports all of the Statistics pages. These endpoints only use approved reviews.

The statistics backend supports:

- Best rated items
- Worst rated items
- Dining commons averages
- Dining commons averages over time
- Meal averages by dining commons

The best and worst item endpoints support a time period and a limit. A negative limit returns an error response.

New data objects were added for item statistics, commons averages, commons averages over time, and meal averages.

Statistics Frontend

The Statistics frontend includes the navbar dropdown, overview page, and the individual statistics pages.

The overview page uses shared page configuration to decide which cards show View and which ones show Coming Soon. This makes it easier to add or enable future statistics pages.

Developer details to be aware of:

- Statistics pages use shared constants.
- Statistics pages fetch data using the shared backend hook pattern.
- Fixtures and tests were added for the new statistics pages.
- The meal averages page uses a dining commons dropdown and updates the table when the selected commons changes.

- Shared files like routes, navbar entries, fixtures, and tests may need careful conflict resolution when multiple statistics pages are developed at the same time.

Deployment Note: The statistics backend must be deployed to main before any frontend statistics pages, as the frontend relies on those new endpoints being live to function correctly.

Average Rating Fix

Average ratings on the menu item table now work because approved reviews are included with menu item responses.

The backend now fetches approved reviews for each menu item before returning the menu item data. Unapproved reviews are not exposed. The frontend already had the average rating calculation, so the main fix was on the backend.

Developer details to be aware of:

- Review serialization was adjusted to avoid circular data problems.
- Menu item responses now include approved reviews.
- Unapproved reviews are filtered out before returning data.
- Controller tests were updated to check that approved reviews are included.

Navigation Refactor

Internal navbar links now use React Router navigation instead of plain HTML links. This prevents full-page reloads when users move between React routes.

Developer details to be aware of:

- Internal app routes use React Router link behavior.
- Backend tool links, such as Swagger and H2 Console, remain plain links because they are not React routes.
- This change does not affect the look of the navbar, only the navigation behavior.

Build and CI Improvements

The frontend and backend build process was cleaned up to make development and CI smoother.

Integration test startup is faster because Maven can skip repeated frontend install and build steps when nothing relevant has changed. The build checks timestamps to decide whether frontend dependencies or frontend source files need to be rebuilt.

Developer details to be aware of:

- The integration profile can skip repeated npm ci and frontend build work.

- Timestamp files are used to track whether dependencies or frontend source files changed.
- Frontend build work still runs when needed.
- Some flaky frontend tests were stabilized.
- React ESLint rules were re-enabled after the Vite migration.
- GitHub Actions workflows were cleaned up and centralized.